

Onboarding Your First 50 Employees

An EWOR Checklist

Onboarding shapes how new hires perceive your team, culture, and role expectations, setting the stage for their success. **A well-structured process fosters engagement, alignment, and motivation from day one.**

For a smooth onboarding process, we recommend the following checklist. It brings in **teams leads** (👤), **senior team members** (👤), and the of course, the **founder** (👤). From there, you can tweak it to fit your organisation's needs!:

Before Their First Day

Complete Administrative Setup



A team leader or senior team member can complete this step.

- Sign the paperwork and finalise all required documents ([contract](#), [NDA](#), [VSOP](#), etc.).
- Send a welcome email with key details (start date, schedule, and first steps)
- Provide access to essential tools and accounts (email, Slack, project management tools).
- Assign a mentor or “buddy” for guidance.
- Prepare their workspace (if in office) or ensure the remote setup instructions are clear and all required items are shipped to them (e.g. company laptop).

Within the First Week

Daily Check-ins



A team lead or senior member can complete this step with the founder.

- Check to see how tasks and team integration are going. If possible, do this twice a day.

Conduct an Onboarding Call or Presentation



This step should be completed by the founder.

- Provide an overview of the company's mission and vision.
- Introduce team members and highlight their roles and capabilities.
- Show warmth and appreciation by explaining why they were chosen and highlighting their strengths.
- Discuss company values with real-world examples.

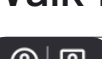
Define Role Expectations



A team lead or senior member can complete this step with the founder.

- Outline specific tasks and goals for the new hire with clearly defined expected outcomes for the trial period.
- Discuss primary responsibilities, KPIs, and how their work contributes to company [OKRs](#).

Walk Through Essential Organisational Tool



A team leader or senior team member can complete this step.

- File Storage (e.g., Google Drive): Ensure access and explain file organisation.
- Communication Tool (e.g., Slack): Explain communication protocols, including rules and best practices.
- Project Management Tool (e.g., Asana or ClickUp): Walk through task management, workflow expectations, and deadlines.

Onboard Additional Tools as Needed



A team leader or senior team member can complete this step.

- Provide training and access to any other necessary tools (e.g., GitHub for developers, Adobe Illustrator for designers).

Within the First Month

Encourage One-on-One Calls With the Team

- Urge new hires to schedule one-on-one calls with team members to build relationships and integrate smoothly.

Host a Team Bonding Activity



A team leader or senior team member can complete this step.

- Organise a personal team dinner, lunch, or game to foster team connections.

Develop a Personal Growth Plan



A team leader or senior team member can complete this step.

- Offer additional training on company tools or processes.
- Create a 90-day (or up to 360-day) skills development plan aligned with their role.

Establish Regular Check-ins



A team leader or senior team member can complete this step.

- Set up weekly check-ins to track progress and answer questions.

By the End of Their Trial Period

End-of-Trial Evaluation Meeting



A team lead could complete this step. However, especially for the first 50 hires, we highly recommend the founder is involved.

- Schedule a formal meeting near the end of the employment trial.
- Prepare your evaluation but remember this shouldn't be a surprise—any concerns should have already been discussed in 1:1s.
- Inform the new hire (with care) whether you're extending their role (permanently) or parting ways.
- Complete the required paperwork for either an extension or their departure.

